Week 1: Group Activity Worksheet

Secret Needs — Observing, Guessing and Solving

Tutorial Objective: Practise design observation. Separate what a person *says* they need from what you can *prove* by observing them, then turn each piece of evidence into solutions you can actually carry out.

Links to Subject Outcomes: Identify the nature of visual information (observation as evidence); start your Visual Journal.

How This Tutorial Runs

Activity	Mode
Briefing and rules	Whole class
Part A – Write your three secret needs	Individual, silent
Part B – Observe and guess your neighbour's needs, with proof	Individual, silent
Part C – Three solutions per proof, with execution plans	Individual
Part D – Teacher-hosted group sharing and reveal	Pairs → groups → class
Part E – Partner comments, reflection, Blackboard upload	Individual

Materials Checklist

☐ 2 memo sheets / sticky notes (Memo 1 = *My Needs*, Memo 2 = *My Guesses*)
☐ 1 envelope or folded paper to hide Memo 1
☐ Pen and pencil; colour marker for highlighting evidence
☐ This worksheet (printed or digital)
☐ Phone or scanner to photograph your memos
☐ Your Visual Journal

Ground Rules

1. **Keep Memo 1 secret** until the teacher calls the reveal. Do not show or tell anyone.
2. **Do not ask your neighbour questions** during Part B. Observe only.
3. Be respectful. Observe objects, behaviours and environments, not body image or private matters.
4. Every guess **must** have visible proof. "I just feel it" is not proof.

Student Information

Field	Details
English Full Name	
Student ID	
Tutorial Class	
Date	

Who Am I Observing? (the student next to you)

Field	Details
Neighbour's Name	
Neighbour's Student ID	
Seating Position *(left / right / front / behind)*	

Sharing Group *(assigned by the teacher in Part D)*

Group Number	Members (names)

Part A: My Three Secret Needs (Memo 1)

*A **need** is something that, if solved, would make your daily life or study noticeably better. It is not just a wish for an object ("I want a new phone"). Ask yourself: what problem sits behind that wish?*

Need Categories (to help you think)

Type	Example
Functional	"I need to carry my laptop without my shoulder hurting."
Emotional	"I need to feel less anxious before presentations."
Social	"I need an easier way to find classmates for group work."
Time / Habit	"I need to wake up on time for 8:30 classes."

A.1 Write Your Needs on Memo 1

Write the three needs on **Memo 1**, fold it, and put it in the envelope. Copy them here **after** the reveal in Part D.

#	My Need	Why It Matters to Me	How Often I Feel It *(daily / weekly / sometimes)*
1			
2			
3			

A.2 Clues I Think I Am Showing

Do you think anyone could see these needs from your belongings or behaviour? List the clues you think are visible.

Part B: Guess Your Neighbour's Needs (Memo 2)

B.1 Observation Scan (silent)

Observe your neighbour quietly. Tick the areas you checked and note what you saw.

Observation Area	☐	What I Observed (facts only, no opinions)
Bag, desk items and stationery	☐	
Phone, laptop and accessories (case, stickers, cables)	☐	
Food, drinks and bottles	☐	
Clothing and accessories that suggest activities	☐	
Behaviour (yawning, checking time, typing, fidgeting)	☐	
How they organise their space	☐	
Other	☐	

Write facts ("three charging cables on desk"), not conclusions ("they are disorganised").

B.2 Write Your Guesses with Proof

Write three guesses on **Memo 2**, then copy them below. Each guess needs **at least two pieces of proof**.

#	Guessed Need	Proof 1 (observed fact)	Proof 2 (observed fact)	Confidence *(H / M / L)*
1				
2				
3				

B.3 Evidence Quality Check

For each guess, tick the strongest type of proof you have:

Guess	Direct object evidence	Repeated behaviour	Environmental clue	Weak / single clue
1	☐	☐	☐	☐
2	☐	☐	☐	☐
3	☐	☐	☐	☐

Part C: Three Solutions for Each Proof

*Design starts with evidence. For **each guess**, write **three different solutions** based on the proof. Try to make the three solutions different in kind: e.g. one **object/product**, one **visual/communication** idea, one **service/habit/system** idea.*

Solution Quality Rules

- **Specific** — "A foldable laptop stand with a strap" beats "something to help".
- **Linked to proof** — say which proof the solution answers.
- **Executable** — you must be able to describe *how* to make or run it.

C.1 Solutions for Guess 1

Guess 1: *(copy from B.2)*

#	Solution (what it is)	Responds to Proof #	Type *(Object / Visual / Service)*
1a			
1b			
1c			

How to Execute

#	Steps to Make or Run It (1 → 2 → 3…)	Materials / Tools / Software	Who & When	Estimated Cost
1a				
1b				
1c				

C.2 Solutions for Guess 2

Guess 2: *(copy from B.2)*

#	Solution (what it is)	Responds to Proof #	Type *(Object / Visual / Service)*
2a			
2b			
2c			

How to Execute

#	Steps to Make or Run It (1 → 2 → 3…)	Materials / Tools / Software	Who & When	Estimated Cost
2a				
2b				
2c				

C.3 Solutions for Guess 3

Guess 3: *(copy from B.2)*

#	Solution (what it is)	Responds to Proof #	Type *(Object / Visual / Service)*
3a			
3b			
3c			

How to Execute

#	Steps to Make or Run It (1 → 2 → 3…)	Materials / Tools / Software	Who & When	Estimated Cost
3a				
3b				
3c				

C.4 Quick Sketch of Your Best Solution

Choose the **one** solution you think is strongest. Sketch it (a product, a poster, an app screen or a service step diagram) and label the key parts.

Chosen Solution #: _____

Part D: Teacher-Hosted Group Sharing

The teacher will guide the class through four rounds.

Round	What Happens
1. Pair Reveal	Swap Memo 2 with your neighbour. Then open Memo 1 and compare.
2. Partner Comments	Your neighbour writes comments on your guesses and solutions (D.2).
3. Group Sharing	Join your group (2–3 pairs). Each person shares one hit, one miss and their best solution.
4. Class Highlights	Each group presents its most surprising "proof" and best solution to the class.

D.1 Reveal Results

Compare your guesses with your neighbour's **real** Memo 1.

Guess #	My Guess	Neighbour's Real Need (closest match)	Result *(Hit / Partial / Miss)*
1			
2			
3			

My accuracy score: ____ Hits / ____ Partial / ____ Misses

Which proof was most misleading, and why?

D.2 Partner Comments *(to be written by your neighbour)*

Neighbour: please be honest, specific and kind. Comment on the accuracy of each guess and how useful each solution would be to you.

Guess #	Was the guess accurate? What did they miss?	Which solution would you actually use? Why?	Usefulness *(1–5)*
1			/5
2			/5
3			/5

Overall comment from neighbour:

Neighbour's signature / name: _____

D.3 Group Sharing Notes

Most surprising "proof" I heard in my group:

Best solution I heard from another student (and why it is good):

A pattern I noticed (e.g. many students share the same need):

Part E: Reflection

E.1 Assumption vs Evidence

Where did I rely on assumptions instead of evidence?

What would I observe differently next time to get better proof?

E.2 Connection to Design

Why is "guess with proof" important for a designer before designing anything?

Blackboard Submission

Upload Checklist

☐ Photo or scan of **Memo 1** (My Three Needs)
☐ Photo or scan of **Memo 2** (My Guesses with Proof)
☐ Completed worksheet Parts A–E (all tables filled)
☐ **Partner comments (D.2)** signed by your neighbour
☐ Sketch of best solution (C.4)

File Requirements

Item	Requirement
Format	One combined PDF
File Name	`W01_[EnglishFullName]_[StudentNumber].pdf`
Location	Blackboard → SSHD2382 → Week 1 → Group Activity
Deadline	End of the tutorial (or as announced by the teacher)

Also copy your memos and reflection into your Visual Journal. They count towards the Process Documentation (30%).

Additional Notes

References & Resources

Use this space to record any references consulted (including any AI tool used and the prompt you gave it):